

Detroit Pistons

2025-2026 Season Guide



Sources:

- [Basketball Reference](#)
- [NBA.com](#)
- [positiveresidual.com](#)

2024-2025 Season Recap



The 2024-25 NBA season represented a major step forward for the Detroit Pistons. After finishing 14-68 (15th in the Eastern Conference) in 2023-24, the team improved to 44-38 (6th in the East) and successfully achieved its primary objective: **returning to the Eastern Conference Playoffs**.

This leap was driven by the continued emergence of **Cade Cunningham** as a franchise cornerstone. Cunningham was voted in by Eastern Conference coaches as an **All-Star Reserve**, earned **All-NBA Third Team** honors, finished 3rd in the Most Improved Player voting, and placed 7th in MVP voting. His growth was solidified as the team’s offensive engine and late-game decision-maker. The supporting cast also made meaningful contributions. **Malik Beasley** finished 2nd for Sixth Man of the Year by providing floor spacing and a scoring punch off-the-bench, while **J.B. Bickerstaff** was recognized as the Coach of the Year runner-up, reflecting the team’s cultural and structural progress.

From a team identity standpoint, the Pistons established themselves as a **physical, defense-first group**, finishing with a **113.1 Defensive Rating** (11th league-wide). Offensively, the team was closer to league average (**115.0 Offensive Rating**, 16th), while playing at an above-average tempo (**99.8 Pace**, 9th). Overall, the Pistons posted a **+1.9 Net Rating** (13th) — a clear indicator of a competitive playoff-caliber team, but with room to grow. Detroit finished **4th in the Central Division**, behind several strong playoff teams. With significant injuries and player movement affecting division rivals, this upcoming season presents a clear opportunity to capitalize on a favorable competitive window.

The postseason ultimately exposed the team’s relative inexperience. The Pistons were unable to close out the New York Knicks at home, ending our playoff run earlier than we had hoped. While injuries played a role, the series highlighted areas where **execution, lineup optimization**, and **late-game adjustments** must improve.

Looking ahead, the roster has undergone meaningful change. The team will move forward without key contributors: **Malik Beasley**, **Tim Hardaway Jr.**, and **Dennis Schröder**, but gains stability with the return of **Jaden Ivey** and **Isaiah Stewart** from injury. Additionally, the acquisitions of **Duncan Robinson** and **Caris LeVert** add shooting versatility and secondary playmaking. Internally, the organization is optimistic about continued development from **Jalen Duren**, **Ausar Thompson**, and **Ron Holland**, each of whom will play a key role in shaping the next phase of the team’s identity.

Statistical Categories	Detroit Pistons	Opponents	Differential
eFG%	54.70%	53.90%	0.80
TOV%	13.00%	13.30%	-0.30
OREB%	26.20%	24.00%	2.20
FTR	24.80%	27.60%	-2.80

Figure 1: Detroit Pistons 2024-25, Four Factors

Cade Cunningham

PG | 6'6" | 220lb | 5th Year

**Last Season: 26.1 PTS | 6.1 TRB | 9.1 AST
35 MP | 46.9 FG% | 35.6 3P% | 52.1 eFG%**



Traditional Box Score

Cade Cunningham finished the 2024–25 season averaging 26.1 PTS, 6.1 TRB, and 9.1 AST per game, while shooting 46.9% from-the-field and 35.6% from three. He functioned as the Pistons’ primary offensive engine and led the team in both scoring and playmaking responsibilities. On the defensive-side, Cunningham averaged 1.0 STL and 0.8 BLK per game.

Per 100 Possessions

Per 100 possessions, Cunningham averaged 35.9 PTS, 8.3 TRB, and 12.5 AST, reinforcing his role as a high-usage initiator rather than a volume scorer operating in isolation. His Offensive Rating (112) and Defensive Rating (113) suggest neutral net impact at the possession level, consistent with a lead guard carrying a heavy offensive burden.

Advanced Statistics

Cunningham was the Pistons’ primary shot creator, posting a 33.2% Usage Rate while attempting 23.1 shots per game. His playmaking responsibilities also expanded significantly, as his Assist Percentage jumped to 43%, a career high and a 5.5% increase from the previous season.

As expected for a high-usage guard, Cunningham’s turnover volume has continued to elevate. He averaged 4.4 TOV per game last season, resulting in a 16% Turnover Rate, the second-highest among NBA players last season. While some of this is an inherent tradeoff of offensive responsibility, reducing live-ball turnovers through improved decision speed and reads against pressure represents a clear area for efficiency gains.

Per 100 Poss	2023-24	2024-25
PTS	32.6	35.9
TRB	6.2	8.3
AST	11.0	13.0
TOV	4.9	6.1
STL	1.3	1.4
BLK	0.5	1.0

Figure 2: Cade Cunningham per 100 Possession Box Score

Cade Cunningham

PG | 6'6" | 220lb | 5th Year

**Last Season: 26.1 PTS | 6.1 TRB | 9.1 AST
35 MP | 46.9 FG% | 35.6 3P% | 52.1 eFG%**



Adjusted Shooting

Cunningham produced solid scoring efficiency given his usage, posting a 52.2% eFG% and 56.4% TS%. He was particularly effective at the free-throw line, converting 84.6% of his attempts, and generated consistent pressure on the rim with a 25.4% Free Throw Rate. This combination indicates a scorer who can sustain efficiency even without elite shooting splits, largely due to foul drawing and shot diversity.

Shot Zone	FGA%	eFG%	Avg. League Differential
Restricted Zone	25.00%	57.00%	-9.00%
Paint	33.00%	50.00%	6.00%
Midrange	13.00%	45.00%	3.00%
Corner 3	1.00%	57.00%	-1.00%
Above-the-Break 3	27.00%	54.00%	1.00%

Figure 3: Cade Cunningham FGA% and eFG% with Average League Comparison

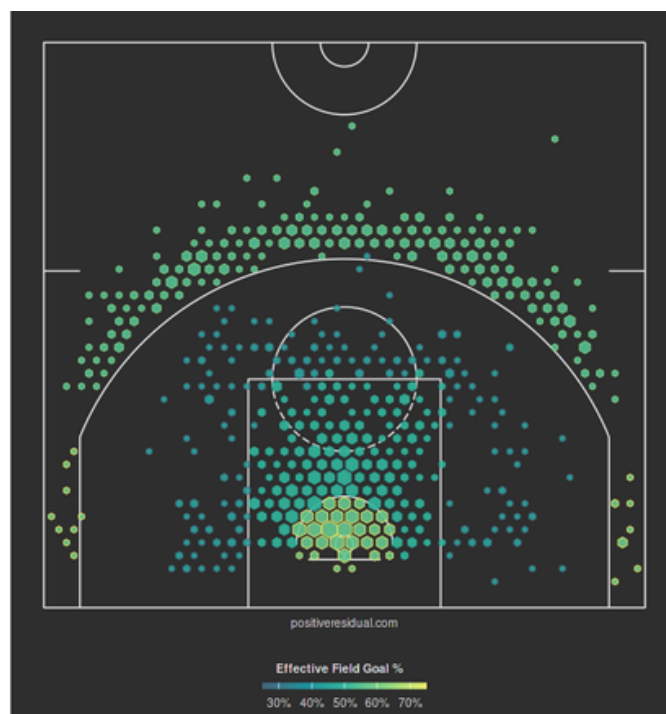


Figure 4: Cade Cunningham Shooting Chart via PositiveResidual.com

Cade Cunningham

PG | 6'6" | 220lb | 5th Year

**Last Season: 26.1 PTS | 6.1 TRB | 9.1 AST
35 MP | 46.9 FG% | 35.6 3P% | 52.1 eFG%**



Play-by-Play

Cunningham played 84% of his minutes at point guard, clearly functioning as the team's primary initiator. His On-Court +/- per 100 possessions (+3.4) and On-Off differential (+3.7) indicate that the team performed meaningfully better with him on the floor, reinforcing his value beyond raw box score production.

62.2% of Cunningham's TOV came from bad passes, highlighting that many mistakes occurred during playmaking rather than ball-handling or scoring attempts. This further supports the idea that streamlining reads and reducing high-risk passes could materially improve offensive efficiency without sacrificing usage. As he continues to be a leader for the Pistons in distributing the ball, he will need to focus on better decision-making on his passes to reduce this volume of TOVs.

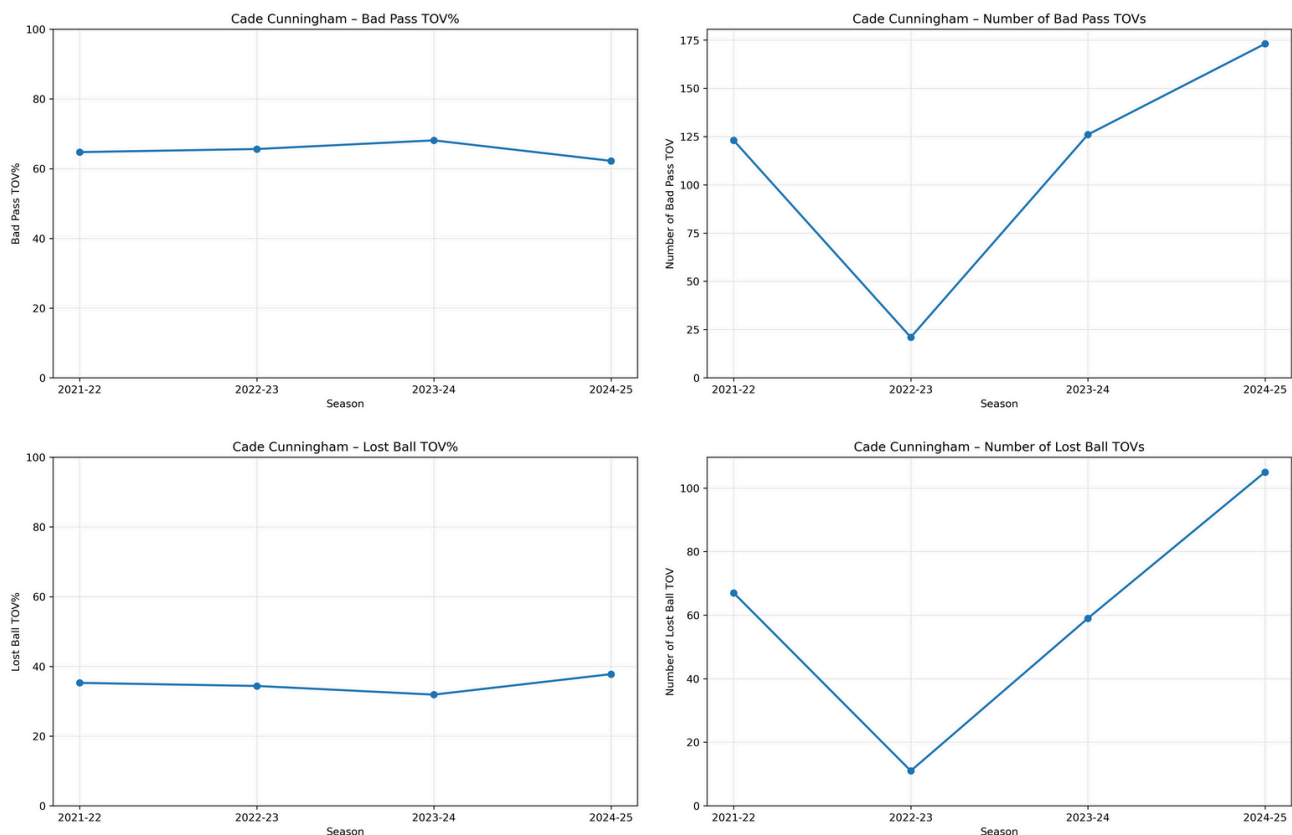


Figure 5: Cade Cunningham TOV Trends

Duncan Robinson

SG, SF | 6'7" | 215lb | 8th Year
Last Season: 11.0 PTS | 2.3 TRB | 2.4 AST
24 MP | 43.7 FG% | 39.3 3P% | 58.1 eFG%



Traditional Box Score

Duncan Robinson finished the 2024-25 season averaging 11.0 PTS, 2.3 TRB, and 2.4 AST per game for the Miami Heat, while shooting 43.7% from the field and 39.3% from three-point range. He functioned primarily as a catch-and-shoot three-point specialist, attempting 6.5 three-pointers per game.

In Detroit, Robinson will be asked to fill a similar role as the team’s primary floor spacer and best pure shooter, particularly alongside Cade Cunningham in the starting lineup.

Per 100 Possessions

Per 100 possessions, Robinson averaged 22.8 PTS, 4.7 TRB, and 4.9 AST. His Offensive Rating (112) and Defensive Rating (117) were both below league-average for Miami, reflecting his limited self-creation role offensively and his defensive vulnerabilities.

For Robinson to remain playable in high-leverage minutes, emphasis must be placed on scheme familiarity, positioning, and team-defense principles, allowing his shooting value to outweigh defensive limitations.

Advanced Statistics

Robinson posted a 19.2% Usage Rate, attempting 9.6 shots per game, reinforcing his role as a low-usage, high-leverage offensive weapon. He maintained a 11.1% Turnover Rate, indicating strong offensive discipline and minimal mistakes—an important trait for a complementary starter playing alongside a high-usage initiator like Cunningham.

Per 100 Poss	2023-24	2024-25
PTS	22.9	22.8
TRB	4.5	4.7
AST	5.0	4.9
TOV	2.5	2.4
STL	1.2	1.1
BLK	0.4	0.2

Figure 6: Duncan Robinson per 100 Possession Box Score

Duncan Robinson

SG, SF | 6'7" | 215lb | 8th Year
Last Season: 11.0 PTS | 2.3 TRB | 2.4 AST
24 MP | 43.7 FG% | 39.3 3P% | 58.1 eFG%



Adjusted Shooting

Robinson delivered elite efficiency in his role, recording a 58.1% eFG% and 59.5% TS%. He was nearly automatic at the free-throw line (88.7% FT%), though his 8.0% Free Throw Rate reflects his perimeter-oriented shot profile rather than rim pressure. A staggering 73% of Robinson’s shot attempts came from beyond the arc, where he converted 39.3% of his three-point attempts. The majority of his threes were Above-the-Break shots (58% of total FGA), while Corner 3s accounted for only 15% of his attempts. This suggests his offensive value is maximized through movement shooting, dribble handoffs, and relocation actions, rather than stationary corner spacing alone.

Shot Zone	FGA%	eFG%	Avg. League Differential
Restricted Zone	14.00%	65.00%	-1.00%
Paint	11.00%	47.00%	3.00%
Midrange	2.00%	38.00%	-4.00%
Corner 3	15.00%	62.00%	4.00%
Above-the-Break 3	58.00%	58.00%	5.00%

Figure 7: Duncan Robinson FGA% and eFG% with Average League Comparison

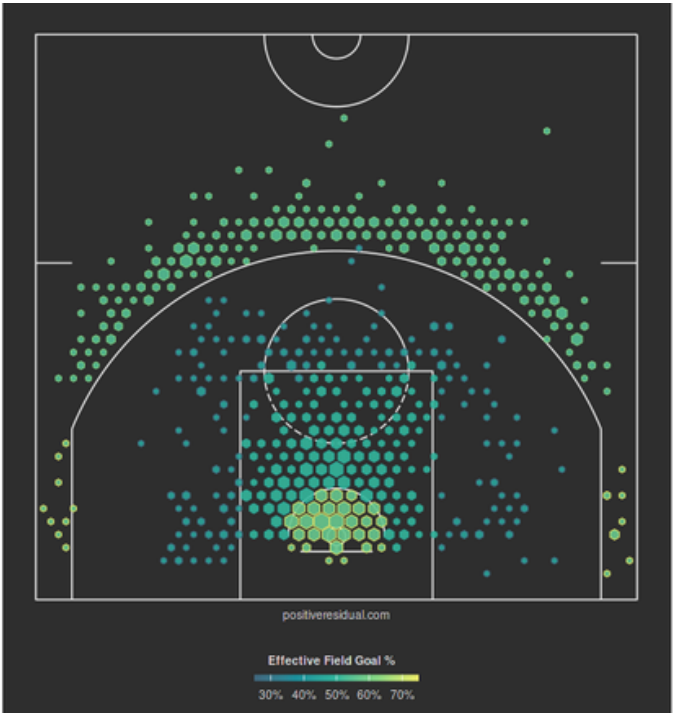


Figure 8: Duncan Robinson Shooting Chart via PositiveResidual.com

Duncan Robinson

SG, SF | 6'7" | 215lb | 8th Year

**Last Season: 11.0 PTS | 2.3 TRB | 2.4 AST
24 MP | 43.7 FG% | 39.3 3P% | 58.1 eFG%**



Play-by-Play

Robinson split his minutes primarily between the wing positions, playing 30% at shooting guard and 59% at small forward, giving the coaching staff lineup flexibility when deploying shooting around ball-dominant guards. His On-Court +/- per 100 possessions (+0.6) and On-Off differential (+0.1) were close to neutral, indicating average lineup impact in Miami's system.

Notably, this production came without a consistent primary playmaker dedicated to generating his looks. In Detroit, Robinson is expected to benefit significantly from Cade Cunningham's playmaking gravity, leading to an increase in high-quality catch-and-shoot opportunities.

Robinson's scoring profile reinforces this projection: 76.0% of his two-point field goals and 88.4% of his three-point field goals were assisted, confirming that the vast majority of his offensive value is generated off the catch rather than through self-creation.

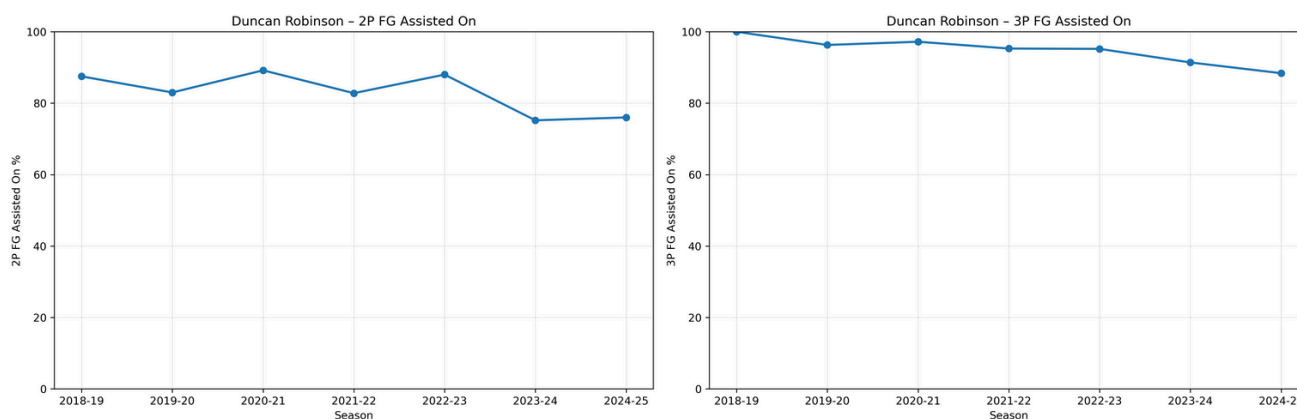


Figure 9: Duncan Robinson FG Assisted On % Trends

Ausar Thompson

SG, SF, PF | 6'7" | 205lb | 3rd Year
Last Season: 10.1 PTS | 5.1 TRB | 2.3 AST
23 MP | 53.5 FG% | 22.4 3P% | 54.7 eFG%



Traditional Box Score

Ausar Thompson finished the 2024-25 season averaging 10.1 PTS, 5.1 TRB, and 2.3 AST per game while shooting 53.5% from-the-field and 22.4% from three. He was the primary point-of-attack defender for the Pistons last season as he was consistently tasked with guarding the best opposing perimeter player. On the defensive-side of the ball, Thompson averaged 1.7 STL and 0.7 BLK per game reflecting his disruptive impact on-the-ball and in passing lanes.

Per 100 Possessions

Per 100 Possessions, Thompson averaged 21.5 PTS, 11.0 TRB, and 4.9 AST. His Offensive Rating (115) and Defensive Rating (108) were strong for the Detroit Pistons as he was a pillar in the Pistons defense.

Advanced Statistics

Thompson held a solid 19.1% Usage Rate for the Pistons while attempting 8.9 shots per game. He averaged 12.6% TRB% with 9.3% ORB%, generating ample amount of extra shot attempts, and 15.9% DRB%, ultimately finishing defensive positions which helped in creating transition offense.

Per 100 Poss	2023-24	2024-25
PTS	16.9	21.5
TRB	12.2	11.0
AST	3.6	4.9
TOV	2.6	2.9
STL	2.1	3.5
BLK	1.8	1.4

Figure 10: Ausar Thompson per 100 Possession Box Score

Ausar Thompson

SG, SF, PF | 6'7" | 205lb | 3rd Year
Last Season: 10.1 PTS | 5.1 TRB | 2.3 AST
23 MP | 53.5 FG% | 22.4 3P% | 54.7 eFG%



Adjusted Shooting

Thompson has shown incremental but meaningful improvement as a shooter. After converting just 18.6% from three in 2023–24, he improved to 22.4% last season. While still below league average, this upward trend is encouraging and underscores the importance of continued shooting development.

More notably, Thompson’s shot selection improved significantly. He shifted his offensive profile toward downhill drives, rim cuts, dunker-spot opportunities, and transition scoring. This is reflected in a 12.1% increase in Restricted Area attempts and a 6.9% increase in Paint attempts, while long midrange and three-point attempts declined.

However, his Paint efficiency dropped to 45.1%, indicating a need for improved touch and finishing through contact. Additionally, Thompson converted just 64.1% of his free throws, a critical area for growth. Without approaching a league-average free-throw rate (approximately 76–78%), opposing defenses can afford to foul him near the rim, limiting the payoff of his aggressive driving style.

Shot Zone	2023-24 FGA%	2024-25 FGA%	Season Differential
Restricted Zone	37.70%	49.80%	12.10%
Paint	28.30%	35.20%	6.90%
Midrange, Short	5.00%	3.30%	-1.70%
Midrange, Long	5.40%	1.10%	-4.30%
3P	23.50%	10.70%	-12.80%
FT	24.80%	30.90%	6.10%

Figure 11: Ausar Thompson FGA% from 2023-24 to 2024-25 with Season Differential

Ausar Thompson

SG, SF, PF | 6'7" | 205lb | 3rd Year
Last Season: 10.1 PTS | 5.1 TRB | 2.3 AST
23 MP | 53.5 FG% | 22.4 3P% | 54.7 eFG%



Shot Zone	2023-24 FG%	2024-25 FG%	Season Differential
Restricted Zone	65.20%	69.00%	3.80%
Paint	54.40%	45.10%	-9.30%
Midrange, Short	45.80%	20.00%	-25.80%
Midrange, Long	30.80%	20.00%	-10.80%
3P	18.60%	22.40%	3.80%
FT	59.70%	64.10%	4.40%

Figure 12: Ausar Thompson FG% from 2023-24 to 2024-25 with Season Differential

Play-by-Play

Thompson split his minutes primarily between small forward (75%) and power forward (23%), providing the coaching staff with lineup flexibility to toggle between bigger and smaller defensive configurations without sacrificing intensity. His On-Court +/- per 100 possessions (+4.3) and On-Off differential (+3.5) clearly indicate that the Pistons were meaningfully better when he was on the floor.

These impact metrics align with his on-court role: generating easy rim opportunities offensively while consistently producing defensive stops.

Thompson drew 62 shooting fouls and converted 9 And-1s last season. As he continues to attack the rim, his foul-drawing frequency should rise. Improving his free-throw efficiency will be essential to fully capitalize on this pressure and unlock additional offensive value as a slashing, defense-first wing.

Tobias Harris

PF | 6'8" | 226lb | 15th Year

**Last Season: 13.7 PTS | 5.9 TRB | 2.2 AST
32 MP | 47.7 FG% | 35.0 3P% | 53.4 eFG%**



Traditional Box Score

Tobias Harris finished the 2024-25 season averaging 13.7 PTS, 5.9 TRB, and 2.2 AST per game while shooting 47.7% from-the-field and 35.0% from three. In addition, he averaged 1.0 STL and 0.8 BLK per game, providing steady two-way production.

Overall, Harris embraced a reduced offensive role in Detroit, prioritizing veteran stability, leadership, and situational reliability for a young roster learning how to win. His willingness to scale usage without sacrificing efficiency was a meaningful factor in the Pistons' improved team performance from the prior year.

Per 100 Possessions

Per 100 Possessions, Harris averaged 20.9 PTS, 9.0 TRB, and 3.4 AST per game reinforcing his value as a low-variance contributor whose impact scaled cleanly with playing time. His Offensive Rating (116) and Defensive Rating (113) were solid for the Detroit Pistons, reflecting a player who consistently contributed to positive possessions on both ends of the floor.

Advanced Statistics

Harris posted a 17.6% Usage Rate, the lowest of his career, while attempting 12.0 shots per game. Rather than driving offense, he found alternative avenues to impact winning — most notably through rebounding and possession finishing.

He recorded a 10.4% Total Rebound Rate, including a 17.5% Defensive Rebound Rate and 3.1% Offensive Rebound Rate, figures that have remained stable dating back to the 2021-22 season. His rebounding reliability helped stabilize lineups and reduce second-chance opportunities for opponents.

Per 100 Poss	2023-24	2024-25
PTS	25.0	20.9
TRB	9.4	9.0
AST	4.5	3.4
TOV	1.9	1.8
STL	1.5	1.5
BLK	1.0	1.2

Figure 13: Tobias Harris per 100 Possession Box Score

Tobias Harris

PF | 6'8" | 226lb | 15th Year

**Last Season: 13.7 PTS | 5.9 TRB | 2.2 AST
32 MP | 47.7 FG% | 35.0 3P% | 53.4 eFG%**



Adjusted Shooting

Tobias Harris has a balanced shot diet, with a little more than half of his shots coming from within 10 feet from-the-basket. He is also very efficient when he shoots inside the Restricted Zone, shooting a whopping 74% eFG%, 8% above league average.

His 3P shot needs some improvement as he is average from the corner, and 7% points below average from Above-the-Break 3. Improving shot quality in these above-the-break attempts, either through better spacing or selective volume, could further elevate his offensive efficiency.

Shot Zone	FGA%	eFG%	Avg. League Differential
Restricted Zone	22.00%	74.00%	8.00%
Paint	29.00%	47.00%	3.00%
Midrange	16.00%	41.00%	-1.00%
Corner 3	15.00%	58.00%	0.00%
Above-the-Break 3	18.00%	46.00%	-7.00%

Figure 14: Tobias Harris FGA% and eFG% with Average League Comparison

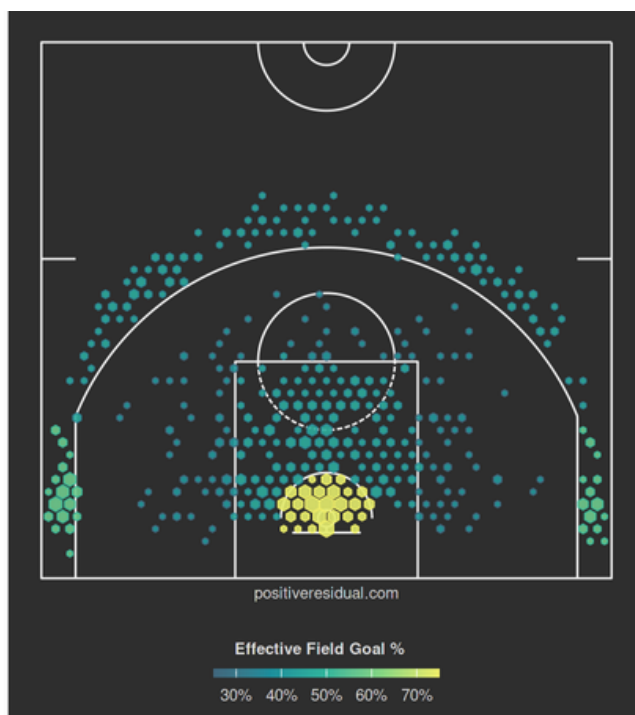


Figure 15: Tobias Harris Shooting Chart via PositiveResidual.com

Tobias Harris

PF | 6'8" | 226lb | 15th Year

**Last Season: 13.7 PTS | 5.9 TRB | 2.2 AST
32 MP | 47.7 FG% | 35.0 3P% | 53.4 eFG%**



Play-by-Play

Harris spent the majority of his minutes at power forward, providing positional stability in both traditional and small-ball lineups. His On-Court +/- per 100 possessions (+3.7) and On-Off differential (+4.1) indicate a consistently positive lineup impact, particularly in mixed veteran-young lineups.

Most notably, Harris posted an 8.8% Turnover Rate, underscoring his ball security, decision discipline, and reliability. In a roster featuring several high-usage creators, Harris functioned as a low-mistake connective piece, helping maintain offensive flow and reduce negative possessions.

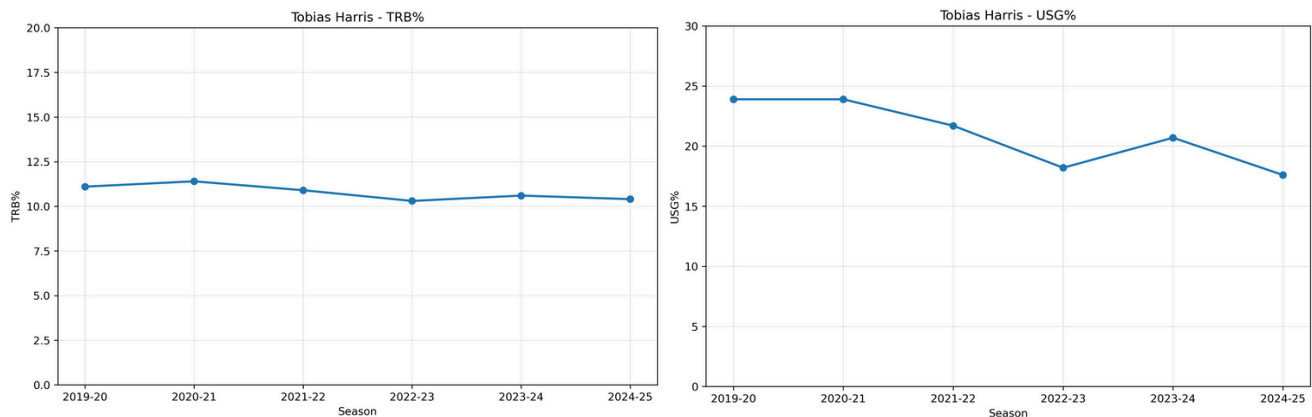


Figure 16: Tobias Harris TRB% and USG% Trends

Jalen Duren

C | 6'10" | 250lb | 4th Year

Last Season: 11.8 PTS | 10.3 TRB | 2.7 AST
26 MP | 69.2 FG% | 69.2 eFG%



Traditional Box Score

Jalen Duren finished the 2024-25 season averaging 11.8 PTS, 10.3 TRB, and 2.7 AST while shooting 47.7% from-the-field in 26 MP. In addition, he averaged 0.7 STL and 1.1 BLK per game anchoring the defense as the rim-protector.

Per 100 Possessions

Per 100 Possessions, Duren averaged 21.7 PTS, 19.1 TRB, and 4.9 AST per game showcasing high-level interior production. His Offensive Rating (134) was elite while his Defensive Rating (109) was solid within the Pistons' defensive structure.

Advanced Statistics

Duren's 16.4% Usage Rate dipped below the previous year's 18.5% Usage Rate. However, Duren was more efficient than ever, setting career highs in both PER (21.4) and TS% (70.3%). He even increased his FTR% to 44.3%, a 12.2% jump from the previous season. In addition, he grabbed 22.0% TRB%, ending defensive possessions with 28.7% DRB% or earning the Pistons additional scoring opportunities with 15.2% ORB%.

Per 100 Poss	2023-24	2024-25
PTS	22.8	21.7
TRB	19.2	19.1
AST	4.0	4.9
TOV	3.5	3.2
STL	0.9	1.3
BLK	1.3	2.1

Figure 17: Jalen Duren per 100 Possession Box Score

Jalen Duren

C | 6'10" | 250lb | 4th Year

**Last Season: 11.8 PTS | 10.3 TRB | 2.7 AST
26 MP | 69.2 FG% | 69.2 eFG%**



Adjusted Shooting

Jalen Duren exclusively shot inside the paint, and he did so at an incredibly efficient pace. Duren boasted a 76.0% FG% inside the Restricted Zone and 55.8% FG% inside the Paint. Out of the his 2P shot attempts, 62.4% were assisted, showcasing his effectiveness in the dunker's spot and as the roll man in pick-and-roll situations. In addition, 219 of his FGA (44.1%) were dunks.

Play-by-Play

Duren spent all of his minutes at center, functioning as the Pistons' primary interior presence. Offensively, he provided strong screening, vertical spacing as a roll man, and efficient finishing in the paint. Defensively, he anchored the middle by contesting shots and securing rebounds to end possessions.

His On-Court +/- per 100 possessions (+1.5) and On-Off differential (-1.1) suggest that while Duren provided individual rim protection and rebounding value, the team defense did not meaningfully improve during his minutes on the floor. This indicates that Duren's defensive impact is currently more event-based (blocks, rebounds) than system-driving at the team level, highlighting an opportunity for growth in areas such as positioning, communication, and coverage versatility.

Duren projects as a defensive difference-maker long-term, but continued growth in coverage recognition and defensive communication will be key to translating individual tools into consistent team-level impact.

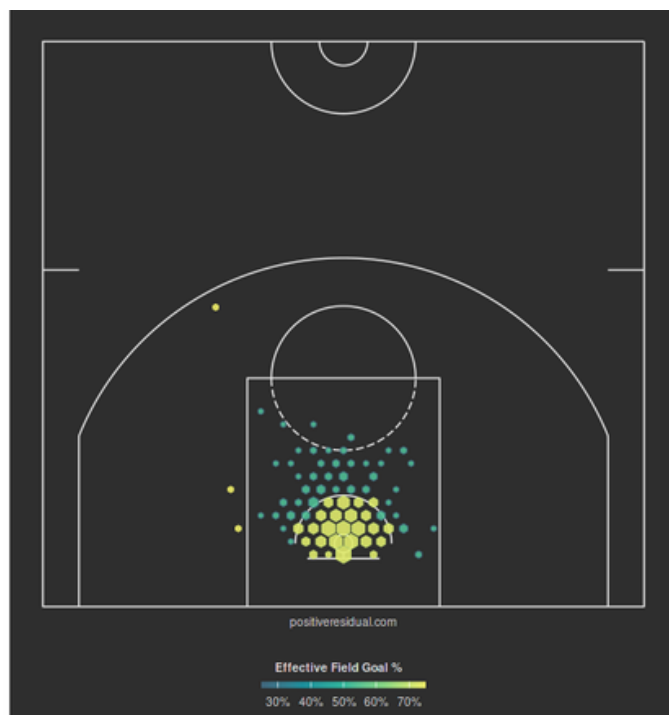


Figure 18: Jalen Duren Shooting Chart via PositiveResidual.com

Isaiah Stewart

C, PF | 6'8" | 250lb | 6th Year
Last Season: 6.0 PTS | 5.5 TRB | 1.7 AST
20 MP | 55.9 FG% | 32.1 3P% | 58.6 eFG%



Traditional Box Score

Isaiah Stewart finished the 2024-25 season averaging 6.0 PTS, 5.5 TRB, and 1.7 AST per game while shooting 55.9 FG% from-the-field and 32.1 3P% in 20 MP. He averaged 0.4 STL and 1.4 BLK per game, and he acted as the first big man off-the-bench.

Per 100 Possessions

Per 100 Possessions, Stewart averaged 14.6 PTS, 13.4 TRB, and 4.1 AST per game showcasing productive minutes off-the-bench. His Offensive Rating (125) and Defensive Rating (110) were solid in providing secondary scoring and defensive stops for the Pistons.

Advanced Statistics

Stewart's 12.4% Usage Rate was a career-low as he transitioned into a defensive role on the team. He posted a 15.4% TRB%, including a 20.6% DRB% and a 10.1% ORB%. In addition, his BLK% increased from 2.3% BLK% the year prior to 6.7% BLK% last season.

Per 100 Poss	2023-24	2024-25
PTS	17.0	14.6
TRB	10.3	13.4
AST	2.5	4.1
TOV	2.2	2.3
STL	0.6	0.9
BLK	1.3	3.4

Figure 19: Isaiah Stewart per 100 Possession Box Score

Isaiah Stewart

C, PF | 6'8" | 250lb | 6th Year

Last Season: 6.0 PTS | 5.5 TRB | 1.7 AST
20 MP | 55.9 FG% | 32.1 3P% | 58.6 eFG%



Adjusted Shooting

Isaiah Stewart grew as a shooter from the 2023-24 season to the 2024-25 season by increasing his efficiency inside-the-arc, getting to the charity stripe more frequently, and being more selective of his 3PA. Stewart notably improved his 10-16 foot efficiency, increasing his accuracy by 18.6 percentage points to 61.5% from that zone. He has shot less efficiently from 3P, but his attempts have also gone significantly down.

Shot Zone	2023-24 FGA%	2024-25 FGA%	Season Differential
Restricted Zone	30.10%	43.80%	13.70%
Paint	21.20%	34.60%	13.40%
Midrange, Short	1.80%	4.10%	2.30%
Midrange, Long	1.00%	0.60%	-0.40%
3P	45.80%	16.80%	-29.00%
FT	22.30%	27.60%	5.30%

Figure 20: Isaiah Stewart FGA% from 2023-24 to 2024-25 with Season Differential

Shot Zone	2023-24 FG%	2024-25 FG%	Season Differential
Restricted Zone	63.50%	68.10%	4.60%
Paint	51.90%	52.30%	0.40%
Midrange, Short	42.90%	61.50%	18.60%
Midrange, Long	25.00%	0.00%	-25.00%
3P	38.30%	32.10%	-6.20%
FT	75.30%	75.90%	0.60%

Figure 21: Isaiah Stewart FG% from 2023-24 to 2024-25 with Season Differential

Isaiah Stewart

C, PF | 6'8" | 250lb | 6th Year

**Last Season: 6.0 PTS | 5.5 TRB | 1.7 AST
20 MP | 55.9 FG% | 32.1 3P% | 58.6 eFG%**



Play-by-Play

Stewart primarily played backup center for the Detroit Pistons providing another option to give Duren rest or when he got into foul trouble. His On-Court +/- per 100 possessions (+0.6) and On-Off differential (-2.1) suggest that Stewart's impact was more situational than lineup-driving, which is consistent with his role as a bench big used for energy, physicality, and rim protection rather than sustained lineup stabilization.

Stewart blocked 101 shots last season, but he also committed 85 shooting fouls. Stewart needs to improve his ability to contest shots vertically and maintain discipline as a secondary rim protector, particularly when defending in rotation rather than as the primary big.

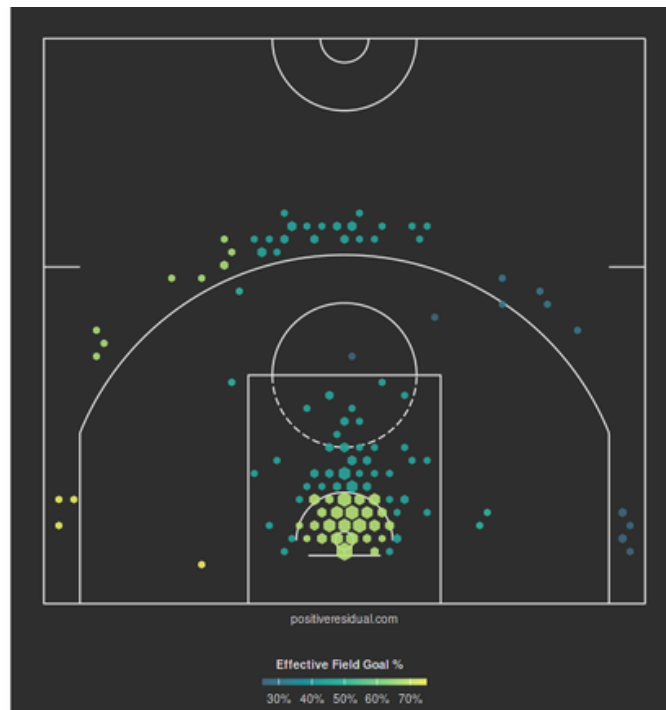


Figure 22: Isaiah Stewart Shooting Chart via PositiveResidual.com

Jaden Ivey

SG | 6'3" | 195lb | 4th Year

**Last Season: 17.6 PTS | 4.1 TRB | 4.0 AST
30 MP | 46.0 FG% | 41.0 3P% | 53.6 eFG%**



Traditional Box Score

Before his injury, Jaden Ivey started 30 games and finished the 2024–25 season averaging 17.6 PTS, 4.1 TRB, and 4.0 AST per game while shooting 46.0% from the field and 41.0% from three in 30 minutes per game. He also contributed 0.9 STL and 0.4 BLK per game, showcasing his athleticism and activity on both ends of the floor.

Per 100 Possessions

Per 100 possessions, Ivey averaged 28.3 PTS, 6.6 TRB, and 6.4 AST. His Offensive Rating (108) was below team average, while his Defensive Rating (115) reflected defensive challenges during his minutes. These numbers are consistent with a high-usage guard taking on expanded creation responsibilities while playing in lineups that lacked defensive stability, particularly prior to his injury.

Advanced Statistics

Ivey posted a career-high 26.0% Usage Rate as his role expanded into a secondary ball-handler and shot creator alongside Cade Cunningham. He produced a respectable 56.9% TS% and a 19.7% AST%, converting scoring opportunities at an efficient clip given his usage. However, his 16.1% TOV% highlights the need for improved decision-making, particularly in tight spaces and double-team situations, as his offensive responsibility increases.

Per 100 Poss	2023-24	2024-25
PTS	25.7	28.3
TRB	5.7	6.6
AST	6.4	6.4
TOV	4.1	4.8
STL	1.2	1.5
BLK	0.9	0.6

Figure 23: Jaden Ivey per 100 Possession Box Score

Jaden Ivey

SG | 6'3" | 195lb | 4th Year

**Last Season: 17.6 PTS | 4.1 TRB | 4.0 AST
30 MP | 46.0 FG% | 41.0 3P% | 53.6 eFG%**



Adjusted Shooting

Ivey shot 46.0% from the field, 40.9% from three, posted a 53.6% eFG%, and finished with a 56.9% TS%. Half of his shot attempts came within 10 feet of the basket, while 37.3% came from three-point range. His jump from 33.6% 3P% the previous season to 40.9% represents meaningful shooting development. Maintaining this efficiency as he returns from injury will be critical to preserving spacing next to Cunningham.

Shot Zone	2023-24 FGA%	2024-25 FGA%	Season Differential
Restricted Zone	22.20%	24.50%	2.30%
Paint	24.90%	24.50%	-0.40%
Midrange, Short	11.80%	9.40%	-2.40%
Midrange, Long	3.20%	4.40%	1.20%
3P	37.90%	37.30%	-0.60%
FT	31.10%	28.10%	-3.00%

Figure 24: Jaden Ivey FGA% from 2023-24 to 2024-25 with Season Differential

Shot Zone	2023-24 FG%	2024-25 FG%	Season Differential
Restricted Zone	65.70%	64.40%	-1.30%
Paint	41.30%	42.60%	1.30%
Midrange, Short	33.90%	33.30%	-0.60%
Midrange, Long	38.70%	33.30%	-5.40%
3P	33.60%	40.90%	7.30%
FT	74.90%	73.30%	-1.60%

Figure 25: Jaden Ivey FG% from 2023-24 to 2024-25 with Season Differential

Jaden Ivey

SG, PG | 6'3" | 195lb | 4th Year

**Last Season: 17.6 PTS | 4.1 TRB | 4.0 AST
30 MP | 46.0 FG% | 41.0 3P% | 53.6 eFG%**

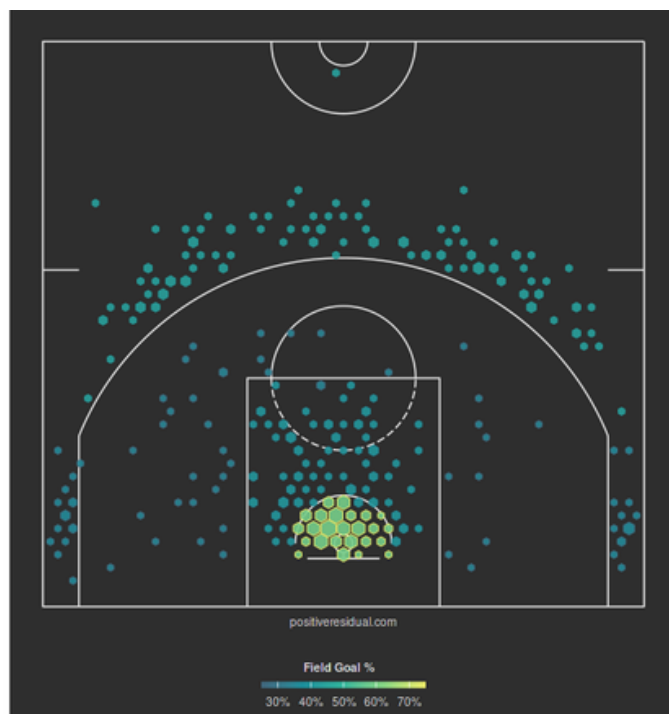


Figure 26: Jaden Ivey Shooting Chart via PositiveResidual.com

Play-by-Play

Ivey spent 76% of his minutes at shooting guard, with additional time at point guard (7%) and small forward (18%), giving the coaching staff flexibility in lineup construction and offensive deployment.

His On-Court +/- per 100 possessions (-3.9) and On-Off differential (-7.6) indicate that lineups featuring Ivey struggled to consistently win possessions, particularly on the defensive end. This suggests that his impact was more volatile than stabilizing, likely driven by a combination of role expansion, lineup context, and defensive inconsistency rather than a lack of effort or offensive value.

As Ivey returns from injury, optimizing his minutes alongside strong defensive lineups and simplifying his offensive reads will be key to unlocking his scoring and playmaking upside without compromising team defense.

Ron Holland

SF, PF | 6'8" | 206lb | 2nd Year
Last Season: 6.4 PTS | 2.7 TRB | 1.0 AST
16 MP | 47.4 FG% | 23.8 3P% | 51.7 eFG%



Traditional Box Score

Ron Holland finished the 2024-25 season averaging 6.4 PTS, 2.7 TRB, and 1.0 AST per game while shooting 47.4% from-the-field and 23.8% from three in 16 minutes per game. He also contributed 0.6 STL and 0.2 BLK per game, showcasing his defense-first, physically imposing play style on the wing

Per 100 Possessions

Per 100 possessions, Holland averaged 19.8 PTS, 8.3 TRB, and 3.1 AST per game. His Offensive Rating (107) was below team average, while his Defensive Rating (113) was slightly above team average. These figures align with a rotational, defense-first wing role rather than an offensive focal point..

Advanced Statistics

Holland posted a respectable 18.1% Usage Rate during his rookie campaign for the Pistons, primarily operating in defensive-oriented lineups. His offensive involvement was secondary to his defensive responsibilities, physicality, and off-ball activity.

Per 100 Poss	2024-25
PTS	19.8
TRB	8.3
AST	3.1
TOV	2.7
STL	1.9
BLK	0.6

Figure 27: Ron Holland per 100 Possession Box Score

Ron Holland

SF, PF | 6'8" | 206lb | 2nd Year

**Last Season: 6.4 PTS | 2.7 TRB | 1.0 AST
16 MP | 47.4 FG% | 23.8 3P% | 51.7 eFG%**



Adjusted Shooting

Holland's offensive role was that of an athletic slashing wing who occasionally shot from beyond the arc. He was above average in the painted area for a wing, while finishing slightly below league average in the Restricted Zone. His perimeter shooting remains a developmental area, as his long-range efficiency was well below league average. If Holland continues to take perimeter attempts, particularly from the corners, meaningful improvement will be necessary to sustain offensive viability.

Shot Zone	FGA%	eFG%	Avg. League Differential
Restricted Zone	38.00%	65.00%	-1.00%
Paint	21.00%	56.00%	12.00%
Midrange	5.00%	40.00%	-2.00%
Corner 3	18.00%	29.00%	-29.00%
Above-the-Break 3	18.00%	43.00%	-10.00%

Figure 28: Ron Holland FGA% and eFG% with Average League Comparison

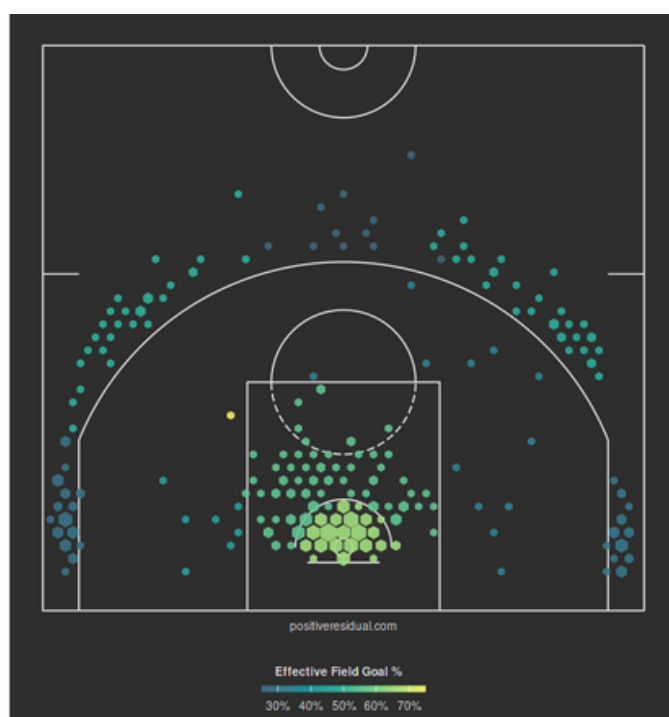


Figure 29: Ron Holland Shooting Chart via PositiveResidual.com

Ron Holland

SF, PF | 6'8" | 206lb | 2nd Year

**Last Season: 6.4 PTS | 2.7 TRB | 1.0 AST
16 MP | 47.4 FG% | 23.8 3P% | 51.7 eFG%**



Play-by-Play

Holland spent 75% of his rookie season at small forward and 23% at power forward, giving the coaching staff flexibility to deploy him in switchable defensive lineups. His On-Court +/- per 100 possessions (-1.0) and On-Off differential (-4.4) suggest situational lineup impact rather than sustained lineup-driving value, consistent with a developmental rotation role.

Among 2024-25 Rookies that played at least 50 games last season, Holland does not profile as a high-volume perimeter shooter. He ranks above average in defensive disruptions (steals + blocks per 36 minutes), placing him among the more active defenders in his class. His moderate three-point attempt rate suggests an offensive role centered on slashing, cutting, and transition play rather than floor spacing. Combined with meaningful minutes played, this profile reinforces Holland's value as a developmental two-way wing whose impact is driven by defensive energy and versatility rather than box score scoring.

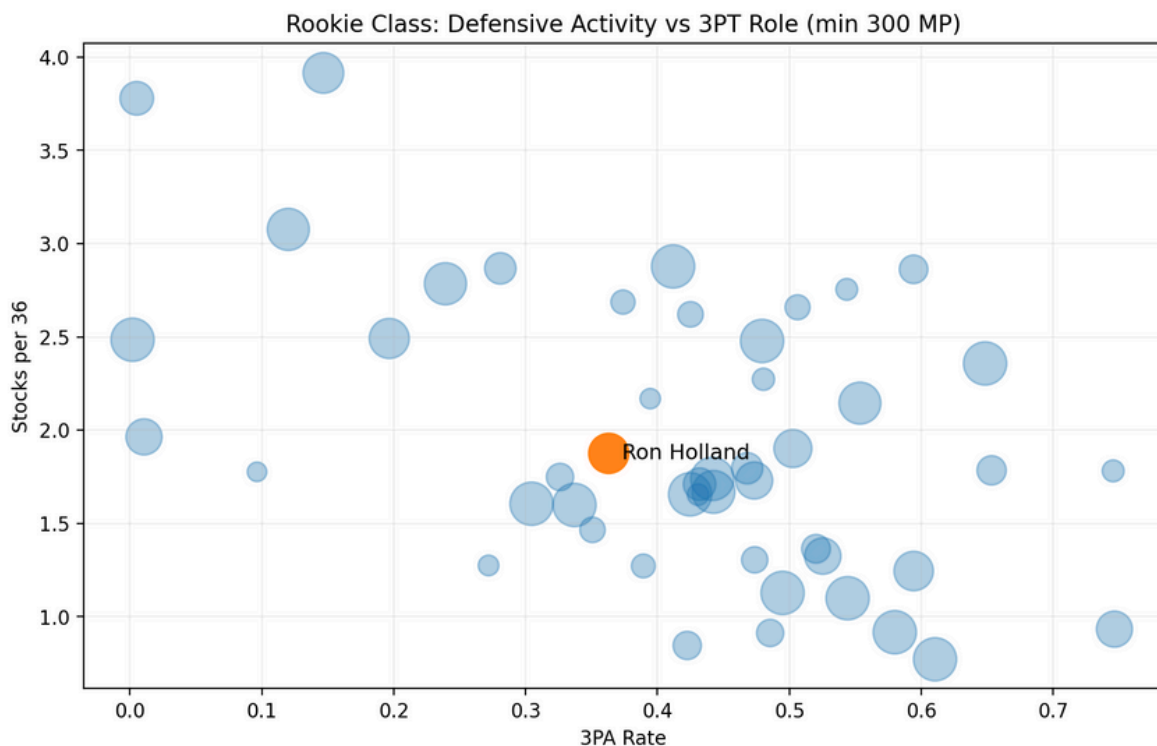


Figure 30: Ron Holland Stocks and 3PA Rate for 2024-25 Rookies

Additional Players

Per 100 Possession Statistics



With Jaden Ivey and Isaiah Stewart returning from injury, Detroit will rely on several second- and third-unit contributors to absorb expanded responsibilities and stabilize lineups early in the season.

- Caris LeVert profiles as the most critical bridge piece, offering reliable secondary creation (23.1 PTS, 6.4 AST per 100 possessions) while maintaining strong efficiency (55.6% eFG%, 37.3% 3P%). His ability to handle on-ball duties allows the offense to remain functional when primary creators rest.
- Marcus Sasser provides additional ball-handling and spacing off the bench, combining shot creation with shooting efficiency (56.1% eFG%, 38.2% 3P%), though his turnover rate suggests the need for simplified reads in extended minutes.
- On the defensive side, Javonte Green and Paul Reed supply energy, physicality, and defensive disruption. Green’s activity (2.5 STL, 1.2 BLK per 100 possessions) makes him a valuable situational stopper, while Reed offers rim protection and rebounding insurance (13.5 TRB, 2.7 BLK per 100 possessions) when front-court depth is tested.
- Daniss Jenkins, though limited in sample size, provides emergency guard depth and ball security coverage if injuries persist.

Collectively, this group will be tasked with maintaining defensive intensity, preserving lineup functionality, and preventing early-season slippage until the roster returns to full strength.

Player	GP	PTS	TRB	AST	STL	BLK	TOV	eFG%	3P%
Caris LeVert	64	23.10	6.00	6.40	1.70	1.00	2.30	55.60%	37.30%
Javonte Green	68	13.30	8.40	2.20	2.50	1.20	1.20	50.90%	32.60%
Paul Reed	45	20.20	13.50	4.80	4.30	2.70	2.90	53.50%	28.60%
Marcus Sasser	57	22.20	4.10	7.90	2.20	0.20	3.20	56.10%	38.20%
Daniss Jenkins	7	14.60	4.20	6.30	0.00	0.00	2.10	35.00%	14.30%

Figure 31: Per 100 Possession Statistics for Additional Players on the 2025-26 Detroit Pistons

Team Identity & General Strategy



Offensive Identity: Transition → Paint Pressure → Advantage Basketball

Detroit's offensive success in 2024-25 was driven by speed, rim pressure, and early offense, not half-court shot-making alone. The Pistons ranked 3rd in the NBA in Fast Break Points percentage (16.0%)¹ and 5th in Points in the Paint (45.8%)², establishing a clear identity as a team that thrives by **attacking before the defense is set** and **finishing inside**.

Based on the 2025-26 Roster, the Pistons' half-court, offensive strategy should be centered around **Cade Cunningham's on-ball gravity** and supported by vertical spacing and shooting around him. With Cunningham functioning as a high-usage initiator. The goal is not isolation-heavy offense, but rather **early advantage creation** through pick-and-rolls, dribble handoffs, and drive-and-kick sequences.

Key Offensive Priorities:

- **Generate easy fast break points in transition**, Detroit should continue to treat transition offense as a foundational scoring source, not a secondary benefit. Fast-break offense reduces half-court offensive burden, limits turnover risk, and maximizes athletic advantages.
 - Defensive activity (steals, blocks, long rebounds) should immediately trigger early pushes
 - Wings like Ausar Thompson and Ron Holland are optimized for open-floor play
 - Bigs should sprint to rim seal early rather than trail for spacing
- **Maximize rim pressure**, Detroit ranked Top-5 in Points in the Paint while maintaining a balanced shot profile, signaling an offense that earns its spacing rather than relying on volume three-point shooting. This approach keeps the offense efficient even during shooting variance nights.
 - Rim pressure from Cunningham, Ivey (upon return), and Thompson forces defensive collapse
 - Vertical spacing from Duren and Stewart creates high-efficiency paint touches
 - Kick-outs should flow naturally from penetration, not from stationary ball movement
- **Half-Court Advantage Creation, Not Shot Hunting**, In the half-court, Detroit's offense should prioritize advantage basketball over shot volume.
 - Early ball screens and dribble handoffs to generate downhill momentum
 - Avoid prolonged isolation sequences that increase live-ball turnover risk
 - Encourage quick decisions: **drive**, **kick**, or **finish**

The offense should emphasize **quick decisions**: shoot, drive, or swing. Reducing possession stagnation will be critical in lowering live-ball turnovers while maintaining high usage for Cunningham.

1 - According to [NBA.com](https://www.nba.com), the Detroit Pistons ranked 3rd in **%PTS_FBP**s

2 - According to [NBA.com](https://www.nba.com), the Detroit Pistons ranked 5th in **%PTS_PITP**

Team Identity & General Strategy



Defensive Identity: Physical → Switch-Capable → Activity-Driven

Defensively, Detroit should continue leaning into its physical, defense-first identity, built around point-of-attack pressure, wing activity, and collective paint protection. This approach was reflected in the Pistons'

ranking 10th in Defensive Rating (112) while finishing 5th in Opponent Points in the Paint (46.3 PTS per Game), signaling a defense that consistently limited interior scoring without relying on a single rim protector.

Detroit's defensive success was driven by containment and activity, not scheme complexity. Players such as Ausar Thompson, Ron Holland, and Isaiah Stewart give the Pistons multiple switch-capable defenders who can apply sustained ball pressure and disrupt offensive rhythm.

Key Defensive Priorities:

- **Win the first action**, apply pressure at the point-of-attack, reducing downhill drives
- **Shrink the floor early**, forcing kick-outs and contested perimeter shots rather than paint finishes
- **Switch selectively** with wing-heavy lineups to reduce rotational stress
- **Protect the paint by committee**, emphasizing positioning, help timing, and communication

Detroit ranked 9th in blocks per game (5.3), but the broader data suggests defensive effectiveness improved most when rotations were limited and penetration was contained, rather than when blocks were chased. This reinforces the importance of **team defense fundamentals**: angle containment, early help, and backside awareness, over event-based defensive outcomes.

Team Identity & General Strategy



Rebounding Identity: Crash → Secure the Ball → Extra Opportunities

Detroit should treat rebounding and possession control as competitive multipliers, particularly against playoff-caliber opponents. The Pistons ranked 11th in defensive rebounding rate (71.4%) and 10th in offensive rebounding rate (30.5%), highlighting a team capable of generating extra possessions through effort, positioning, and timing rather than sheer size.

Offensively, Detroit's rebounding activity translated into results, finishing 9th in second-chance points (14.8 per 100 possessions). Players such as Jalen Duren, Isaiah Stewart, and Ausar Thompson were key contributors, combining interior presence with wing activity to extend possessions.

However, this aggression came with trade-offs. Detroit ranked 19th in opponent second-chance points allowed (14.4), indicating that rebounding must be situational rather than automatic, especially against teams with elite shooting or transition threats.

Key Rebounding Priorities:

- Crash selectively from the weak-side wing when matchups and floor balance allow
- Prioritize defensive rebounding over transition offense against high-efficiency shooting teams
- Limit live-ball turnovers, particularly from primary handlers, to prevent opponent runouts

Given Detroit's pace, winning possession battles allows the team to maintain tempo without sacrificing efficiency, but only when rebounding decisions are aligned with personnel, matchups, and game context.

Dynamic Adjustments: Lineup Flexibility → Opponent-Specific

While the Pistons should maintain a consistent identity, lineup flexibility is a strategic strength. The coaching staff should be prepared to adjust based on opponent profile:

- **Against drop-coverage teams:** Increase Cunningham-Duren pick-and-roll volume and short-roll playmaking
- **Against switch-heavy defenses:** Use Robinson's off-ball movement and guard-guard screening to force miscommunications
- **Against elite perimeter shooting teams:** Deploy Thompson/Holland-heavy lineups to prioritize defensive containment
- **Late-game situations:** Optimize for decision-makers and free-throw shooters, even at the expense of size

The roster supports situational specialization, allowing the staff to lean into offense-defense substitutions without fully abandoning continuity.

Team Identity & General Strategy

Dynamic Adjustments: Lineup Flexibility → Opponent-Specific

While the Pistons should maintain a consistent identity, lineup flexibility is a strategic strength. The coaching staff should be prepared to adjust based on opponent profile:



- **Against drop-coverage teams:** Increase Cunningham-Duren pick-and-roll volume and short-roll playmaking
- **Against switch-heavy defenses:** Use Robinson's off-ball movement and guard-guard screening to force miscommunications
- **Against elite perimeter shooting teams:** Deploy Thompson/Holland-heavy lineups to prioritize defensive containment
- **Late-game situations:** Optimize for decision-makers and free-throw shooters, even at the expense of size

The roster supports situational specialization, allowing the staff to lean into offense-defense substitutions without fully abandoning continuity.

Team Strengths & Weaknesses

Four Factors Analysis



To better understand Detroit's strengths and weaknesses from the 2024-25 season, we examined game-level differentials across the Four Factors and their relationship to point margin. Rather than isolating wins and losses, combining both provides a clearer view of which variables consistently scaled with performance and which functioned as secondary or contextual factors.

eFG% Analysis

Across the full season, games in which Detroit posted a positive eFG% differential overwhelmingly correlated with positive point margins, while negative eFG% differentials clustered with losses. This aligns with league-wide findings: shot quality and conversion efficiency remain the most reliable predictors of game outcomes.

For Detroit specifically, this relationship reinforces the offensive identity identified earlier in the report. The Pistons ranked:

- 3rd in Fast Break Points (%PTS from FBPS - 16%)
- 5th in Points in the Paint (%PTS - 33.3%)

These advantages manifest directly in eFG%, particularly in transition and rim-adjacent scoring. When Detroit successfully generated early offense and interior looks, efficiency rose and wins followed. Conversely, when forced into half-court possessions without paint access, eFG% dropped sharply and margins suffered.

Key takeaway: Shot quality is the primary swing factor for Detroit's success.

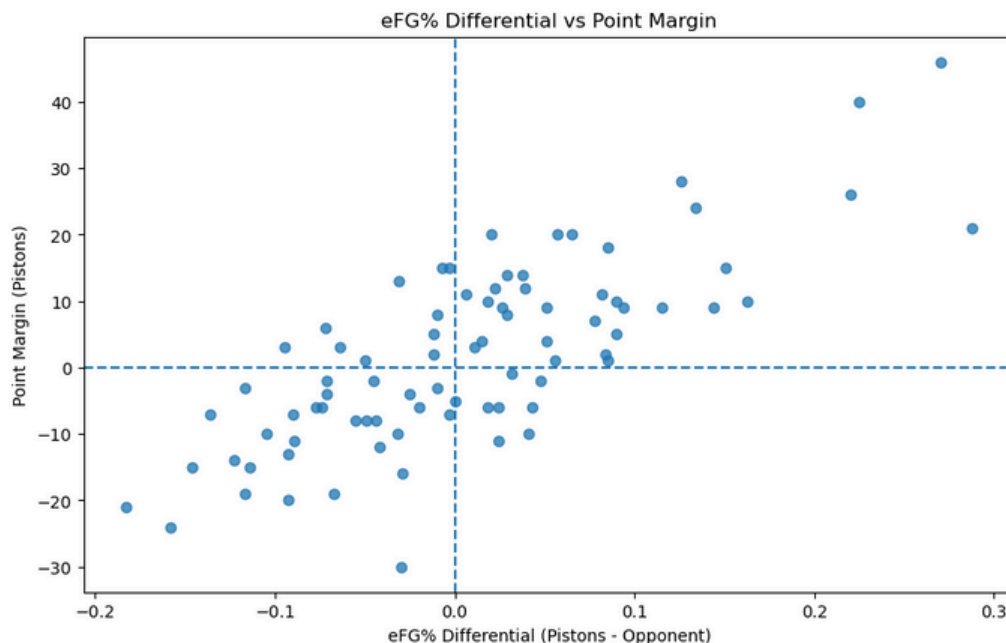


Figure 33: Detroit Pistons 2024-25, eFG% vs Point Margin

Team Strengths & Weaknesses

Four Factors Analysis



TOV% Analysis

Turnover differential did not display a strong linear relationship with point margin across Detroit's 2024-25 games, as losses occurred both when the Pistons won and lost the turnover battle. This suggests that turnover percentage alone was not a primary driver of game outcomes. Instead, the impact of turnovers was highly context-dependent. Many of the most damaging turnovers occurred in already-losing game states, particularly live-ball turnovers from primary ball handlers that led directly to opponent fast-break opportunities. In these situations, turnovers functioned less as the cause of losses and more as an accelerant, widening margins by fueling transition scoring and preventing Detroit from leveraging its half-court defensive structure. Compared to shooting efficiency, which influences nearly every possession, turnovers affected outcomes unevenly based on timing, location, and game flow.

Key takeaway: Turnovers did not determine whether Detroit won or lost games, but they significantly influenced how quickly losses escalated once control of the game was lost.

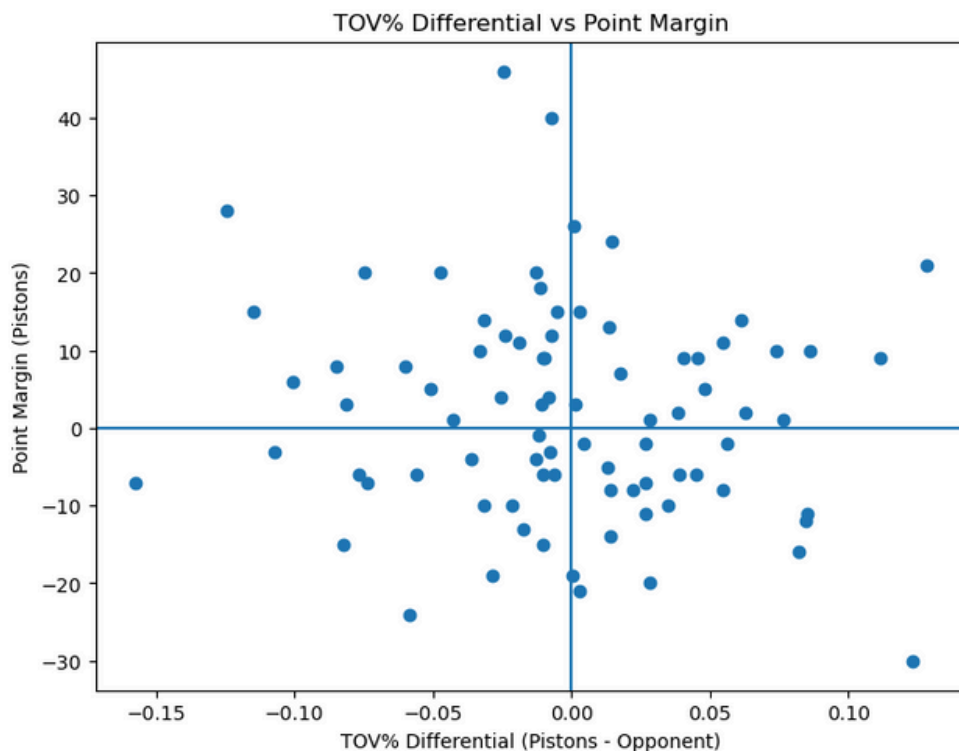


Figure 34: Detroit Pistons 2024-25, TOV vs Point Margin

Team Strengths & Weaknesses

Four Factors Analysis



ORB% Analysis

The relationship between OREB% differential and point margin is present but far weaker and more variable. While Detroit ranked:

- 10th in OREB% (30.5%)
- 9th in Second-Chance Points (14.8)

the game-level scatterplot shows significant dispersion. Strong offensive rebounding performances occurred in both wins and losses, suggesting that offensive rebounding alone does not guarantee positive outcomes.

This supports a more nuanced interpretation:

- Offensive rebounds function as possession multipliers, not primary drivers.
- Their value increases when paired with efficient scoring on initial possessions.
- Against elite shooting teams, aggressive crashing can even become counterproductive by exposing transition defense.

Key takeaway: Offensive rebounding is a supporting advantage, not a standalone solution.

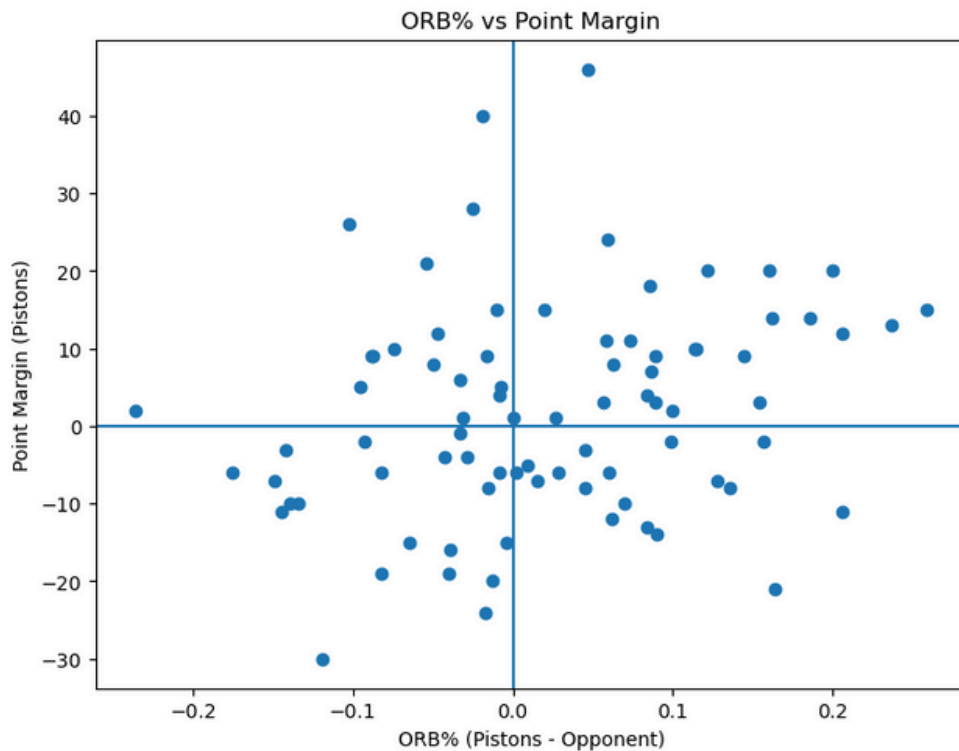


Figure 35: Detroit Pistons 2024-25, ORB vs Point Margin

Team Strengths & Weaknesses

Four Factors Analysis



FTR% Analysis

Free Throw Rate differential exhibits the weakest direct relationship with point margin among the Four Factors in Detroit's data.

While drawing fouls remains valuable — particularly for players like Cade Cunningham and Jalen Duren — the scatter indicates that:

- Positive FTR differentials occurred in both wins and losses.
- Several strong wins featured neutral or even negative FTR differentials.

This reflects two realities:

1. FTR is highly context-dependent (officiating, opponent style, game flow).
2. Free throws amplify efficiency when paired with strong eFG%, but rarely compensate for poor shot quality.

Detroit's profile supports this interpretation. The team's offensive success was driven more by pace, paint pressure, and transition scoring than by living at the free-throw line.

Key takeaway: Foul drawing enhances good offense; it does not rescue inefficient offense.

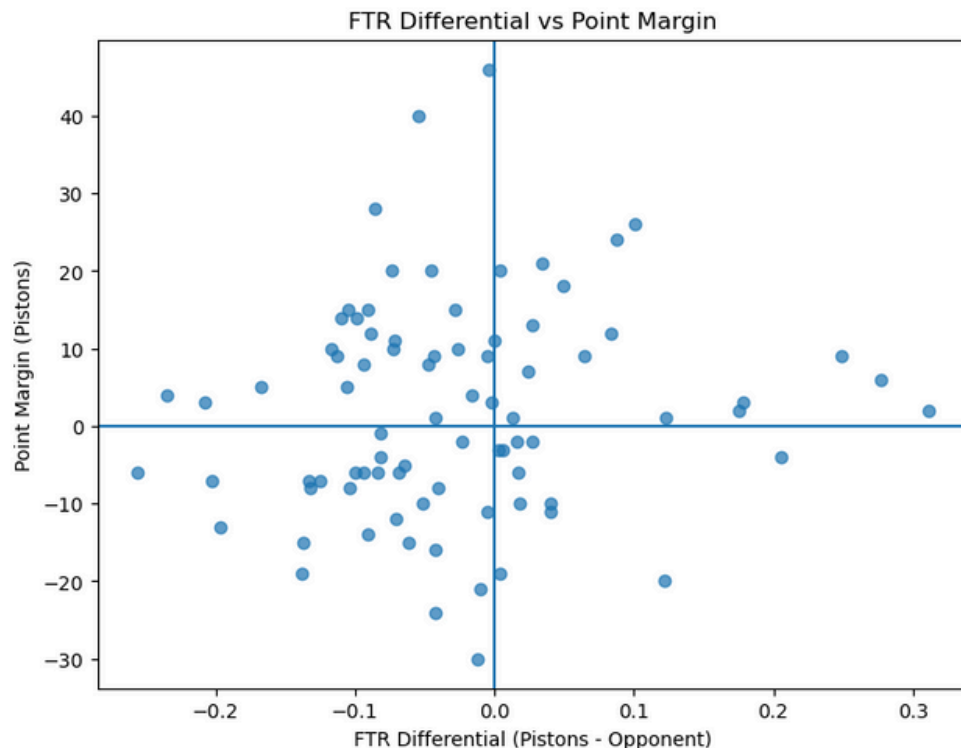


Figure 36: Detroit Pistons 2024-25, FTR% vs Point Margin

Team Lineups - 2-Man Lineup



Best Players to Pair with Cade Cunningham

3PT Marksman (Spacing Specialist)

During the 2024-25 season, Cade Cunningham's most effective two-man pairing by Net Rating was with Malik Beasley. Over 70 games and 1,228 minutes, the Cunningham-Beasley duo posted a +5.5 Net Rating, driven by a 113.4 Offensive Rating and a 107.9 Defensive Rating. Beasley's off-ball shooting gravity and willingness to operate as a low-usage floor spacer allowed Cunningham to orchestrate the offense with increased driving lanes and cleaner passing reads.

Although Beasley departed in free agency, Duncan Robinson profiles as a functional replacement within this role archetype. Robinson offers comparable three-point volume and efficiency, along with similar off-ball usage patterns. While defensive tradeoffs may exist, the underlying offensive inputs that powered the Cunningham-Beasley pairing (spacing, shot gravity, low turnover burden) remain replicable within Detroit's current roster construction.

Rim-Rolling Big (Primary P&R Partner)

Among front-court partners, Jalen Duren emerged as Cunningham's most effective pick-and-roll complement. Across 66 games and 1,545 minutes, the Cunningham-Duren pairing produced a +3.2 Net Rating, supported by a 116.6 Offensive Rating. Duren's vertical spacing, screen-setting, and finishing efficiency created consistent advantages for Cunningham in half-court actions, particularly against drop coverage.

Entering the upcoming season, continued development and familiarity between Cunningham and Duren suggest further upside. As timing, screening angles, and decision-making improve, this pairing projects as a foundational offensive connection for Detroit's core lineup structure.

Challenging Pairings with Cade Cunningham

Secondary Ball Handler (Usage Overlap Risk)

The Cunningham-Jaden Ivey pairing produced a -4.4 Net Rating across 26 games and 520 minutes, driven primarily by a 116.5 Defensive Rating and reduced offensive efficiency. While the sample size is limited and impacted by injuries, the data suggests early challenges related to role overlap, decision-making congestion, and defensive containment when both players operate as primary creators.

Importantly, this result should not be interpreted as a definitive incompatibility. Rather, it highlights the need for clearer role definition, staggered usage, and lineup context when deploying multiple high-usage guards. With improved spacing and clearer offensive hierarchy, this pairing remains a developmental variable rather than a fixed liability.

Partner Player	Offensive Rating	Defensive Rating	Net Rating
Malik Beasley	113.40	107.90	5.50
Jalen Duren	116.60	113.40	3.20
Jaden Ivey	112.10	116.50	-4.40

Figure 37: Cade Cunningham Pairings and Net Ratings

Team Lineups - 4-Man Lineup



Best Players to Form a 4-Man Lineup

Cunningham, Rolling Big, Defensive Slasher, and 3&D

During the 2024-25 season, Cade Cunningham, Jalen Duren, Tim Hardaway Jr., and Ausar Thompson served as the Pistons best 4-Man lineup. Over 44 games and 610 minutes together, they posted an excellent +6.8 Net Rating, driven by a 116.5 Offensive Rating and a 109.7 Defensive Rating. This lineup functioned effectively because each player filled a clearly defined, complementary role without overlapping responsibilities. Offensively, the presence of Tim Hardaway Jr. as a high-volume perimeter shooter provided essential spacing, allowing Cade Cunningham to operate efficiently as the primary creator. This is reflected in the lineup's strong eFG% (56.1%), TS% (58.8%), and a healthy AST/TO ratio of 1.86, indicating efficient ball movement with controlled risk. Jalen Duren's rim pressure and screening created vertical spacing, while Ausar Thompson's cutting, transition play, and offensive rebounding (34.0% OREB%) added possession value without demanding usage.

Defensively, this group maintained structure and physicality. Thompson anchored point-of-attack defense, Duren protected the paint and secured rebounds (75.4% DREB%), and the lineup avoided excessive fouling or turnovers, keeping opponents out of scramble situations. The result was a balanced defensive performance that complemented the offense rather than relying on high-variance events.

While Hardaway Jr. is no longer on the roster, the success of this lineup highlights a repeatable formula:

1. Cunningham surrounded by
2. a true shooting threat, → Duncan Robinson
3. a vertical rim presence, → Jalen Duren
4. an athletic defensive wing → Ausar Thompson

Replicating these functional roles should allow Detroit to recreate similar lineup-level success moving forward.

Team Lineups - 4-Man Lineup



Challenging Players to Form a 4-Man Lineup

Ivey, Hardaway Jr., Harris, Duren

This four-man lineup struggled significantly over 335 minutes, posting a -5.5 Net Rating driven by a 122.7 Defensive Rating, which overwhelmed its strong 117.2 Offensive Rating. This unit highlights how offensive efficiency alone is insufficient when defensive structure and role balance break down.

Offensively, the lineup actually performed well in isolation. The group posted strong eFG% (58.2%) and TS% (60.8%), moved the ball frequently (65.4% AST rate), and played at a slower, controlled pace (97.2). However, much of this efficiency came from shot-making rather than sustainable advantage creation. With Jaden Ivey and Tobias Harris both operating as secondary creators alongside Cade-less lineups, possessions often stalled into late-clock situations that limited downhill pressure and rim frequency.

Defensively, this lineup consistently failed to contain penetration and recover in rotation. The lack of a true point-of-attack stopper on the perimeter placed excessive strain on Duren as the lone interior anchor, leading to breakdowns that resulted in high-quality opponent looks. While rebounding rates remained respectable (52.9% REB%), the group's inability to limit initial advantages led to repeated defensive scrambles and an inflated Defensive Rating.

Most notably, this lineup illustrates the downside of pairing multiple offense-leaning players without a defensive organizer on the floor. The absence of a pressure defender or switch-capable wing reduced lineup flexibility and exposed structural weaknesses that opponents consistently exploited.

Lineups	Offensive Rating	Defensive Rating	Net Rating
T. Hardaway Jr. - C. Cunningham - J. Duren - A. Thompson	116.5	109.7	6.8
T. Harris - T. Hardaway Jr. - J. Ivey - J. Duren	117.2	122.7	-5.5

Figure 38: Best and Challenging 4-Man Lineups from the 2024-25 Season

Team Lineups - Situationals



Scenario	1	2	3	4	5
Starters	C. Cunningham	D. Robinson	A. Thompson	T. Harris	J. Duren
Reserves	J. Ivey	C. LeVert	R. Holland	P. Reed	I. Stewart
Situational	D. Jenkins	M. Sasser	J. Green		
Defensive	C. Cunningham	A. Thompson	R. Holland	T. Harris	I. Stewart
Free Throw	C. Cunningham	D. Jenkins	D. Robinson	T. Harris	J. Duren
Small Ball	C. Cunningham	D. Jenkins	J. Ivey	D. Robinson	T. Harris
Tall	C. Cunningham	A. Thompson	R. Holland	T. Harris	J. Duren

INTENTIONAL PAGE BREAK